and who regard not the beauty and excellence, but the cheapness of an article.' Bernier believes that the arts of the Indies 'would long ago have lost their beauty and delicacy, if the Monarch and principal Omrahs did not keep in their pay a number of artists'.

Moreover, a 'profound and universal ignorance is the natural consequence of such a state of society'. 'Is it possible,' asks Bernier, 'to establish in Hindoustan academies and colleges properly endowed? Where shall we seek for founders? Or, should they be found, where are the scholars? Lastly . . . where are the benefices, the employments, the offices of trust and dignity, that require ability and science and are calculated to excite the emulation and the hopes of the young student?' As if this wasn't enough social anthropology to reckon with, Bernier also seems to have anticipated Adam Smith, born thirty-five years after his death in 1688:

> Nor can the commerce of a country so governed be conducted with the activity and success that we witness in Europe; few are the men who will voluntarily endure labour and anxiety, and incur danger, for another person's benefit—for a governor who may appropriate to his own use the profit of any speculation.
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> . . . to conclude briefly I must repeat it; take away the right of private property in land, and you introduce, as a sure and necessary consequence, tyranny, slavery, injustice, beggary and barbarism: the ground will cease to be cultivated and become a dreary wilderness; in a word, the road will be opened to the ruin of Kings and the destruction of Nations. It is the hope by which a man is animated, that he shall retain the fruits of his industry, and transmit them to his descendants, that forms the main foundation of everything excellent and beneficial in this sublunary state; and if we take a review of the different kingdoms in the world, we shall find that they prosper or decline according as this principle is acknowledged or contemned: in a word, it is the prevalence or neglect of this principle which changes and diversifies the face of the earth.

Bernier accompanies Aurangzeb's large entourage to a retreat in Kashmir, 'one of the most beautiful countries in the world'. The Kashmiris, he writes,

> are celebrated for wit, and considered much more intelligent and ingenious than the Indians. In poetry and the sciences, they are not inferior to the Persians. They are also very active and industrious [and] proverbial for their clear complexions and fine forms . . . The women especially are very handsome; and it is from this country that nearly every individual, when first admitted to the court of the Great Mogol, selects wives or concubines, that his children may be whiter than the Indians and pass for genuine Mogols.

Near Kashmir Bernier also meets a leader from the 'Lama tribe' of Tibet, led by a very old 'Grand Lama', who, nearing death, 'assembled the council, and declared to them that his soul was going to pass into the body